

Bodhi Linux 2.4.0 arrives



Here's an interesting bit of news from the Bodhi Linux camp. Jeff Hoogland has recently announced a new release of Bodhi Linux six whole months after its previous version 2.3.0 was released. This announcement finally brings new features as well as indicates what the future plans are.

This release is based on Linux 3.8, Enlightenment 17.4, and Midori 0.5.5. Hoogland mentioned, "As always, our default theme selection has been shaken up." Bodhi Linux is available in a 32 bit version featuring a PAE kernel, a 32 bit version with a non-PAE kernel, and a 64 bit version. You can download the release at Sourceforge or as Hoogland says, "Those applying the regular system updates should already have the equivalent of 2.4.0."

In addition to the new version, Hoogland also mentioned a change in the Bodhi Linux release schedule. According to his statement, Bodhi will receive three yearly updates starting immediately instead of the previous schedule of four updates. Based on this, users can now expect releases in January, June and September. Talking about the 3.0.0 release, Hoogland said, "Can you believe it is almost the end of 2013 already? That means Bodhi 3.0.0 is less than twelve months away! It will be out some time in the summer after Ubuntu 14.04 releases."

Google has also increased its contribution. The report also revealed the top 10 organisations that sponsor Linux kernel development. They are Red Hat, Intel, Texas Instruments, Linaro, SUSE, IBM, Samsung, Google, Vision Engraving Systems, Consultants and Wolfson Microelectronics.

Valve's Gabe Newell says Linux is the future of PC gaming

Valve's Gabe Newell is sure that the future of PC gaming lies in the Linux kernel. According to reports, the founder of Valve promised everyone at LinuxCon in New Orleans, that his company would provide more details of its Linux-based hardware in the coming week. "Next week we're going to be rolling out more information about how we got there and what are the hardware opportunities we see for bringing Linux into the living room," Develop-Online.net quoted Newell as saying.

Game developers have distinct advantages on Linux since the operating system opens the field to a variety of very powerful tools and options. These wouldn't be available to them on any other platform. But, just like the advantages, there are major disadvantages as well. Currently, there are no professional quality graphical debuggers for Linux, which would be very useful alongside graphically intensive applications. Further, audio is a major problem with Linux distributions.

The report said that Valve's work over the past year or so has been trying to bridge these gaps. Further, it also states that the company has ported many well known titles including 'Left 4 Dead -2'.

Here comes 'Marryo', the open source remake of the classic Mario

Ever thought of creating more personalised Mario levels? Well, our favourite Mario was unfortunately not open sourced, but its open source remake 'Marryo' is! Yes, the open

source world brings a new spin to the classic game. The 'Secret Marryo Chronicles' comes with Mario-style side-scrolling, cartoon-style graphics and music that you would definitely relate to.

The open source 'Secret Marryo Chronicles' is a worthwhile diversion for any gamer. And what's even more interesting is that if you know a trick or two about playing with the codes, you can easily create your own Marryo levels.

'The Secret Marryo Chronicles' will not be high on Mario nostalgia like other remakes as you'll not find any pixel art here. The game has a good vector-based visual style of its own, which gives an impression of an interactive version of a fan's drawings. It's an initial shock but once you get familiar with it, it's charming.

You can easily find a majority of the gameplay elements from Mario, like the 'Question boxes' to open with your head, the Goombas to squish with your feet, and mushrooms that inexplicably cause you to grow twice your size. And like with the original, you have to jump over pits and obstacles in an attempt to move from left to right.

